

Spiritual Gems and Bible Reading — Week of July 27-August 2, 2026

Bible reading: Jeremiah 20-21 | Assigned reading: Jeremiah 20:7-18 *"What spiritual gems from this week's Bible reading would you like to share?"*

15 comment options + 2 research/insight angles (highlighted in blue in the HTML/PDF). Each comment is about 20-30 seconds spoken. The options avoid the Treasures verses (Jer 20:2, 8, 9, 11) and the official Spiritual Gems question (Jer 20:12).

#	Verse	What I take away
1	Jer 20:1	A spiritual position does not automatically make a person receptive
2	Jer 20:3	Jeremiah resumed his assignment immediately after mistreatment
3	Jer 20:6	False teaching can harm the people closest to us
4	Jer 20:7	Jehovah allows his servants to express painful feelings honestly
5	Jer 20:10	Jeremiah's apparent friends watched for him to fail
6	Jer 20:13	Faith can move us to praise Jehovah before distress is completely over
7	Jer 20:14-18	A faithful servant can experience a severe emotional low
8	Jer 21:1, 2	Zedekiah wanted Jehovah's help without first changing his course
9	Jer 21:3, 4	Jeremiah did not soften Jehovah's answer for the king
10	Jer 21:5	Jehovah's power benefits only those who remain on his side
11	Jer 21:8	Even late in the crisis, Jehovah placed a choice before the people
12	Jer 21:9	Obedience can require doing what seems humiliating or unsafe
13	Jer 21:12	Justice was to be upheld promptly, "every morning"
14	Jer 21:13	Natural advantages can produce dangerous overconfidence
15	Jer 21:14	Jehovah holds people accountable according to their deeds
R1	Jer 20:7, 13-18	 <i>Insight book:</i> discouragement did not mean Jeremiah had abandoned Jehovah
R2	Jer 21:1, 2, 8, 9	 <i>Insight book:</i> Zedekiah asked for help but lacked courage to obey

1 • Jeremiah 20:1

A leading commissioner was listening

Jer 20:1 identifies Pashhur as both a priest and a leading commissioner in Jehovah's house. Yet his position did not make him receptive to Jehovah's message. That warns me not to rely on a title, experience, or privileges as proof that I am spiritual. What matters is whether I listen humbly when God's Word corrects my thinking.

2 • Jeremiah 20:3

On the following day

Jer 20:3 impresses me because Jeremiah had just spent a night in the stocks, but when he was released, he immediately delivered Jehovah's message to Pashhur. He did not let mistreatment silence him or make him dilute the warning. Courage does not mean that pain has no effect on us. It means that loyalty to Jehovah still directs our next step.

3 • Jeremiah 20:6

All your friends

Jer 20:6 says that Pashhur had prophesied lies to his friends. His false teaching did not affect only him; it gave people close to him a false sense of security and helped put their lives in danger. This reminds me that what I say about Jehovah carries responsibility. Loving our family and friends means giving them truth, not merely telling them what feels reassuring.

4 • Jeremiah 20:7

I have become a laughingstock

In Jer 20:7, Jeremiah spoke very openly to Jehovah about feeling overpowered, ridiculed, and humiliated. Jehovah preserved those words in the Bible instead of condemning Jeremiah for expressing them. That reassures me that prayer does not need to hide painful emotions. Jehovah already knows our heart, and he lets loyal servants speak honestly while he helps them regain a balanced view.

5 • Jeremiah 20:10

Watching for my downfall

Jer 20:10 shows that some men who claimed to wish Jeremiah peace were actually waiting for him to make a mistake. That kind of hidden opposition must have been especially painful. Still, Jeremiah did not reshape Jehovah's message to win their approval. His example helps me remember that loyalty is tested not only by open hostility but also by the desire to please people around us.

6 • Jeremiah 20:13

Sing to Jehovah!

Jer 20:13 is striking because Jeremiah calls on others to praise Jehovah while his own troubles are still very real. Faith allowed him to view Jehovah's rescue as certain, even before every painful feeling had disappeared. When I am under pressure, recalling how Jehovah protects and sustains his servants can give me a reason to praise him now, not only after the trial has ended.

7 • Jeremiah 20:14-18

Why did I have to come out of the womb?

Jer 20:14-18 records a severe emotional low in the life of a faithful prophet. Jeremiah's distress did not erase his long record of loyalty, and Jehovah did not reject him for feeling overwhelmed. This helps me avoid judging a faithful person by one difficult moment. A discouraged servant may need patient support and reassurance, not the added burden of feeling spiritually defective.

8 • Jeremiah 21:1, 2

Perhaps Jehovah will perform one of his wonderful works

In Jer 21:1, 2, Zedekiah asked Jeremiah to seek Jehovah's help when Babylon threatened Jerusalem. But he seemed to want a miracle without first correcting the disobedience that had caused the crisis. This warns me not to treat prayer as an emergency measure while resisting Jehovah's direction. Real trust includes being willing to change, not only asking Jehovah to remove consequences.

9 • Jeremiah 21:3, 4

This is what you should say to Zedekiah

Jer 21:3, 4 shows that Jeremiah gave the king Jehovah's answer exactly as directed, even though it was the opposite of what the king hoped to hear. Jeremiah respected royal authority, but he feared Jehovah more. In the ministry, people may prefer a more comfortable answer. We can imitate Jeremiah by speaking tactfully while never reshaping the Bible's message to gain approval.

10 • Jeremiah 21:5

I myself will fight against you

Jer 21:5 is sobering because the people knew that Jehovah possessed a mighty arm, but now that power would be directed against them. Simply bearing Jehovah's name did not guarantee his support. This teaches me never to take my friendship with Jehovah for granted. His power is a source of safety when I loyally stay on his side and respond to his correction.

11 • Jeremiah 21:8

The way of life and the way of death

Jer 21:8 shows Jehovah's mercy even at a very late point. Judgment on Jerusalem was certain, but individuals were still placed before a clear choice between life and death. Jehovah did not hide the way to survive. This helps me see the urgency of our ministry. A strong warning is loving when it clearly shows people the course that leads to life.

12 • Jeremiah 21:9

Whoever goes out and surrenders

According to Jer 21:9, survival required surrendering to the Chaldeans. To human thinking, that could look cowardly or disloyal, but in that situation it was obedience to Jehovah. The verse teaches me that courage is not always standing and fighting. Sometimes courage means setting pride aside and following Jehovah's direction when it feels humiliating, unpopular, or opposite to my natural instinct.

13 • Jeremiah 21:12

Uphold justice every morning

Jer 21:12 says that the royal house should uphold justice "every morning" and rescue the person being robbed. Justice was not something to postpone until it became convenient. Those with responsibility had to act promptly and consistently. This reminds me that concern for someone who is being treated unfairly should move me to helpful action, not remain only a sympathetic feeling.

14 • Jeremiah 21:13

Who will come down against us?

Jer 21:13 reveals the false confidence of Jerusalem's inhabitants. Their location made them feel so secure that they asked who could possibly invade them. But no terrain or defense could protect them from the results of disobedience. I learn not to let stable circumstances, ability, or past success create spiritual overconfidence. Real security always depends on maintaining Jehovah's approval.

15 • Jeremiah 21:14

As your deeds deserve

Jer 21:14 says that Jehovah would hold the people accountable as their deeds deserved. Their confident claims did not change the evidence of how they had acted. This teaches me that Jehovah's judgment is never superficial or arbitrary. He looks at what a person actually does. That motivates me to make my daily conduct agree with the faith and loyalty I profess.



R1 · Jeremiah 20:7, 13-18 — *Insight book connection*

Discouraged, but still calling on Jehovah

The *Insight* article on Jeremiah notes that he became discouraged at times but never stopped calling on Jehovah for help. Jeremiah 20 makes that clear: his words swing from deep pain to confident praise and back to anguish. His emotions were not simple, but his loyalty endured. This can help us distinguish temporary discouragement from loss of faith and respond compassionately to those who are struggling.



R2 · Jeremiah 21:1, 2, 8, 9 — *Insight book connection*

A request for help required courageous obedience

The *Insight* material describes Zedekiah as a vacillating king. Jeremiah 21 helps us see that weakness: the king asked Jehovah for a wonderful rescue, but Jehovah's answer required the humbling step of surrender. This teaches me that seeking Jehovah's guidance is only the beginning. Courage is shown when we obey the answer, especially when it is not the answer we hoped to receive.

Bible Reading Assignment — Jeremiah 20:7-18

Study 2: Conversational Manner

Main objective

Read naturally and sincerely, conveying Jeremiah's changing feelings without turning the passage into a dramatic performance. The listener should hear a real servant of Jehovah moving through ridicule, determination, confidence, praise, and deep anguish.

Suggested emotional flow

Verses	Feeling to convey	Reading approach
7-8	Hurt and humiliation	Begin reflectively; stress "laughingstock," "ridicules," "insults," and "jeering" without sounding bitter
9	Inner struggle and conviction	Pause after "I will speak no more in his name"; then build warmth and strength through "burning fire" and "I could no longer endure it"
10	Pressure and betrayal	Use a slightly quicker, tense pace for the rumors and quoted accusations; slow down at "watching for my downfall"
11-12	Renewed confidence in Jehovah	Let the voice become steadier and firmer; emphasize "Jehovah was with me" and "to you I have committed my legal case"
13	Praise and relief	Read warmly and positively, giving the short exclamations room to breathe
14-18	Deep anguish	Shift to a subdued, measured tone; convey pain sincerely but avoid excessive drama

Practice reminders

- Become familiar enough with the passage to look up naturally at sensible breaks.
- Let the punctuation guide the pace; do not rush the poetic lines.
- Keep quoted words distinct through tone, especially in verses 9 and 10.
- Use feeling, but preserve the dignity of the Bible account.
- Aim to finish comfortably within four minutes rather than reading at maximum speed.

Verified source pages

- English meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-July-27-August-2-2026/>
- Tagalog meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/tl/library/jw-workbook-para-sa-pulong/hulyo-agosto-2026-mwb/Iskedyul-ng-Pulong-Para-sa-Buhay-at-Ministryo-Para-sa-Hulyo-27-%E2%80%8BAgosto-2-2026/>
- English Bible reading: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/bible/study-bible/books/jeremiah/20/>
- Tagalog Bible reading: <https://www.jw.org/tl/library/bibliya/bibliya-para-sa-pag-aaral/aklat/jeremias/20/>